

Beyond the Bump: Understanding Fathers' and Partners' Experiences with Digital Technologies for Parenthood

Lena Rechberger

Department of Informatics and Media

Uppsala University

Uppsala, Sweden

lena.rechberger@im.uu.se

Abstract

Gendered preconceptions about parenthood tend to be reflected in the design and usage patterns of digital technologies, as previous research has shown. However, HCI studies on parenthood technologies have so far focused primarily on motherhood and women's experiences, and there is a lack of research on fathers' perspectives. This is why in my PhD project I aim to explore how digital technologies mediate and co-construct contemporary experiences of fatherhood in Sweden. To achieve this, I will put user experiences into conversation with the interaction design of commercially available applications a) to study fathers' perspectives in and with digital technologies used in the context of parenthood; and b) to provide a critical feminist analysis of the socio-cultural entanglements of these technologies with gender relations in a Nordic context. I employ a qualitative approach that includes interviews and walkthrough analyses, culminating in a series of co-design workshops.

CCS Concepts

• **Human-centered computing** → Human computer interaction (HCI); Empirical studies in HCI.

Keywords

Fatherhood, Apps for Parents, Gender, Care, Caring Masculinities, Feminist HCI

ACM Reference Format:

Lena Rechberger. 2026. Beyond the Bump: Understanding Fathers' and Partners' Experiences with Digital Technologies for Parenthood. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI EA '26)*, April 13–17, 2026, Barcelona, Spain. ACM, New York, NY, USA, 5 pages. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3772363.3799194>

1 Introduction

Technologies have moved from the workspace into the private sphere and are now an integral part of our everyday lives, homes, families and relationships. With the rise of (self-)tracking technologies and mobile applications it has become common for people to collect personal data about themselves and their lives for a variety of purposes [16]; and this includes even the most intimate areas of life, such as pregnancy and parenthood. It is safe to say that most of

our everyday experiences are mediated by technology. Following Blackwell [9], we can therefore see how "... technology becomes a lens through which to understand being human in a changing world."

One aspect of our world that has been changing significantly are gender relations and parenting practices, in particular in the Nordic countries, which are often regarded as role models in these areas. 'New fathers' in Sweden have received a lot of attention in research, however, there remain significant differences between the ideals of new fatherhood and its implementation in everyday practice, which is reflected in the fact that fathers still spend less time with their children [39]. Statistics for Sweden also show that women take more parental leave to care for (young) children than men, work part time more often and tend to spend more time on childcare and housework [35]. A systematic literature review covering primarily the US and Europe on mental load, i.e. the cognitive dimension related to unpaid work in the home, states that it is higher in women, in particular when related to children and parenting [33]. These findings support the notion that women are assumed to be the primary caregiver and shoulder a significant amount of parenting responsibility, even in the seemingly progressive Nordic countries. Gender equality therefore still faces significant challenges, especially considering parenthood, which is characterized by biological realities on the one hand, and essentialized socio-cultural assumptions and gendered norms on the other hand.

Understanding technology and society as mutually shaping each other, I am reasoning that digital technologies as socio-cultural artifacts reflect these societal preconceptions and conditions in their design and therefore shape user's perceptions of and experiences with them, as well as work to enable or restrict courses of action in their personal lives to some extent. This is because individual and cultural understandings of parenthood are mediated not only by laws and policies, but also by media, literature and other socio-cultural artefacts [39], which includes mobile applications [30]. Following Bardzell's [8] call for Feminist HCI, there have been increasing numbers of studies on motherhood, but studies on fatherhood have mostly been missing so far. Inspired by Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities (CSMM), my approach is to use 'the other parent' as a less common starting point to explore the experiences of those who occupy a differently gendered position in the journey to parenthood, therefore offering a complementary perspective. This is why in my PhD project I focus primarily on fathers and non-pregnant parents and their experiences with digital technologies used in the context of parenthood. Highlighting these perspectives in this particularly gendered context originates from a social justice motivation in line with Feminist HCI, as I believe that



This work is licensed under a Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License. *CHI EA '26, Barcelona, Spain*

© 2026 Copyright held by the owner/author(s).

ACM ISBN 979-8-4007-2281-3/2026/04

<https://doi.org/10.1145/3772363.3799194>

an improved understanding on this subject can ultimately help us to design technologies that support a more (gender) equal distribution of responsibilities and facilitate the chance for fathers and partners to become more involved in parenthood from the very beginning.

1.1 Prior work

Research on fatherhood has received only limited attention in HCI. A few scholars have pointed out this gap and the need for more research on men in connection with fatherhood [2, 3, 32]. There are however a few notable exceptions, for example a study on pregnancy tracking, where the researchers interviewed both pregnant and non-pregnant stakeholders (including partners) to gain a better understanding of collaborative tracking practices [28]. They also conducted another study targeting social relations in the context of pregnancy, that takes into account stakeholders beyond the pregnant person, finding that apps don't consider stakeholder's different roles enough [27]. A review of preconception care apps found that if apps were aimed at both partners, they tend to center mostly on women with little information for men [31]. Several design-oriented projects have aimed at providing wearables or other types of tangible technology that enable users to share aspects of the pregnancy experience with a partner or others [12, 18, 20, 22, 23, 25, 38]. Ammari and Schoenebeck provide valuable contributions on the topic of fatherhood online; they conducted interview studies to explore how fathers use online resources and social media in relation to fatherhood [2] and to find out more about the online identities and experiences of stay-at-home dads in particular [3]. Similarly, [21] explored social media and app use of fathers in a Danish context, contrasting previous findings from the US. Another study looked at how first-time fathers in a Southeast Asian context search for information about pregnancy online [1]. An experiment on the use of do-it-yourself language and visuals on parenting blogs showed that it does not have a positive effect on father's engagement in childcare [29]. Another study investigates gender differences in discussion topics on parenting forums on Reddit [4]. Partner's involvement is also relevant in the context of breastfeeding, which is addressed by the design of a gamified app for breastfeeding interventions engaging both parents [36]. Overall, however, the focus in HCI is still on motherhood (see [7] and [37]), leaving a gap in terms of fathers' and partners' experiences and also reproducing the notion that parenthood is primarily a women's issue. Even though many aspects of pregnancy and early parenthood are intimately bound to the female body, it is not only possible, but necessary to broaden the focus beyond this and learn more about the particular position taken on by the parents who do not bear children themselves. This is in line with Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities (CSMM), which highlight the need to also study men and their experiences from a gender perspective. The experiences of fathers and partners as a unique starting point for analyzing the phenomenon of parenthood could reveal themes related to (dis)embodiment, mediated intimacy, temporal disjunction and relationality, that differ from those of mothers. This knowledge on fatherhood has the potential to complement existing research on technology use throughout the journey to parenthood and provides a more holistic picture that could enable the design of technologies that promote compassion, mutual understanding and cooperation for both parents.

1.2 Aim and research questions

The aim of this dissertation is to explore how digital technologies mediate and co-construct contemporary experiences of fatherhood as well as gender relations between parents. To achieve this, I will put user experiences into conversation with the interaction design of commercially available tracking applications, taking a critical feminist perspective and considering the socio-cultural context of the Nordic countries. The objectives of my research are: to explore fathers' and partners' experiences of living with digital technologies used in the context of parenthood; and to provide a critical feminist analysis of the socio-cultural entanglements of these technological artefacts and gender relations in order to reimagine their design and use. To operationalize this, I ask the following research questions:

- How do fathers and partners experience and live with digital technologies used in the context of parenthood?
- How is the interaction design of these technologies entangled with socio-cultural norms related to gender and parenthood?
- How can we design alternative technologies that support the unique needs and experiences of fathers and partners during conception, pregnancy and early parenthood?

In my project I address the currently underexplored intersection between two domains that are differently gendered: (self-)tracking technologies, often embedded with masculinist logics of control, optimization, and datafication, and parenthood, which is historically feminized, embodied, and relational. By studying technologies for parenthood from the perspective of fathers and partners, I aim to untangle the unspoken but pervasive assumptions about gender that are prevalent in these domains to expose tensions, contradictions and possibilities for alternatives. My main contribution therefore lies in identifying and theorizing this intersection as a site where design and gender norms are mutually negotiated and contested.

1.3 Outline of planned studies

The dissertation is planned as a compilation thesis. It encompasses four to five articles that exemplify the overarching research questions and focus on the three main aspects of lived experiences, technological artefacts, and alternative designs. The red thread throughout my dissertation is a critical feminist perspective in studying fathers, partners and gender relations, which means that the goal is not only to understand the status quo, but also to criticize it and to look at potential alternatives, in particular from a gender equality perspective. Here is a preliminary outline of the planned studies:

1. Putting fatherhood on the map: Theorizing men and masculinities in the context of digital technologies
2. From the sidelines: Fathers' and partners' experiences with pregnancy apps
3. Sharing parenthood: how technologies mediate couples' negotiation and division of responsibilities
4. Reimagining fathers'/partners' participation in the journey to parenthood & Designing for equal parenthood

With the first article I propose to put fatherhood on the research agenda in HCI. It will map out the existing work on men, masculinities and fatherhood in the field and outline the gaps to suggest new

directions for research, in particular within the context of reproduction and parenthood. Another part will be to introduce relevant concepts and theories from Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities and discuss how they might provide useful perspectives for studying these issues. The second and third articles are empirical studies, including interviews with individual fathers and partners as well as dyadic interviews with couples about their experiences with apps used during pregnancy and early parenthood. These insights are combined with walkthroughs of commonly used apps to understand how fathers and partners are considered and represented in the design, and how interactional features enable or hinder participation and shared responsibility. The fourth (and potentially fifth) article will build on previous results to explore alternative design spaces through co-design workshops with fathers, partners and couples, focusing on the unique needs and experiences of fathers and partners and to enable equal sharing of responsibilities.

1.4 A note on language

Socio-cultural representations of parenthood, including those embedded in digital technologies, are often shaped by heteronormative perspectives and binary understandings of gender that fail to reflect the diversity of families and lived experiences. At the same time, heterosexual couples are particularly affected by gender norms that assign specific roles and responsibilities to mothers and fathers, frequently resulting in traditional and unequal divisions of care after becoming parents. In my dissertation, I aim to highlight the experiences of non-pregnant partners across gender identities, bodies, and sexual orientations, as their perspectives on parenthood have often been overlooked. However, drawing on Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities, I also want to emphasize the importance of studying men as gendered beings and theorizing fatherhood as gendered phenomenon. I therefore try to use gender-inclusive rather than gender-neutral language where possible (for referenced literature I use the terminology chosen by the authors). Aware of the role of language in reproducing heteronormative and binary systems, I continuously reflect on how I present my research and welcome any feedback on improving my writing in this regard.

2 Theoretical Framework

My dissertation is situated at the intersection of Feminist HCI, Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities (CSMM) and fatherhood studies within sociology, drawing on various theories related to gender relations, masculinity and care. A scoping review on masculinities in HCI points out the importance of recognizing not only women, but also men as gendered and to address men as agents for necessary social change [34]. This in line with basic premises of CSMM, which emphasizes the importance of conducting research on men as gendered beings, as well as seeing men and masculinities as socially constructed in a particular context and keeping a critical view on men's position within gendered power relations derived from feminist scholarship [19]. As I position my research on fatherhood within this critical tradition on masculinities and gender relations, I consider my research as following Bardzell's call for including gender perspectives into HCI research [8]. Within the topical area of men, masculinities and reproduction, Lohan suggests a theoretical framework, which is "feminism-informed, reflecting

on the social shaping of intimate relationships across societies, on the materiality of the body, and on technologies in intimate relationships" [26]. She also notes the importance to consider how both the institutional organization of social life and everyday experiences of men are interconnected [26]. Within fatherhood studies, Doucet's seminal work 'Do Men Mother?' discusses caregiving practices of fathers who act as primary caregivers and her concept of 'fathering' as a situated, relational and embodied practice provides the theoretical foundation to understand fatherhood in connection with modern technologies [13]. My research on fatherhood is drawing on care as a central concept within feminist scholarship and studies of parenthood, which is why the theoretical framework of caring masculinities (CM) [15] plays an important role in understanding how fathers might contest common masculinity ideals and how they develop new masculine identities and practices. CM builds on feminist ethics of care and highlights the role of positive emotions, interdependence and relationality, suggesting that CM can be understood as reflecting a social change towards gender equality. Others take a more critical stance and understand these changing practices as a form of hybrid masculinities [11, 40], which incorporate some elements of care while mostly keeping hegemonic structures and existing gender inequalities intact. I continue to engage with these theoretical perspectives outlined above to see how they can help me understand my empirical material and how I can use them to build a theoretical framework for my dissertation.

3 Methodological approach

The qualitative approach I follow in my dissertation project is inspired by the ethnographical tradition in HCI [14], as I aim to provide an in-depth understanding of the people who live with technologies of parenthood and reveal underlying assumptions, values and power relations that shape the interactions with these technologies. Understanding applications as socio-cultural artefacts [30] means that I am also interested in the affordances, limitations and cultural representations embedded in the interaction design of popular applications.

The material for the empirical studies is collected using three main methods: qualitative interviews, app walkthroughs [24] and co-design workshops. The interviews focus on the lived experiences of fathers and partners on their journey to parenthood, as well as on dyadic interviews with couples about the early stages of parenthood, and discuss the role of commercial applications in these processes. Based on the findings from the empirical studies and the analysis, I then plan to conduct co-design workshops with fathers, partners and couples as a way to move beyond critique and explore alternative ways of designing. The goal is not to develop design implications for a particular artefact, but rather to open up a design space and develop design inspirations as a vision for a way forward (see [14]). Here I might incorporate concepts or tools from Value-Sensitive Design as it provides designers with a framework to work with issues such as (ethical) values, direct and indirect stakeholders, benefits and harms and value conflicts [17].

The main method for data analysis is reflective thematic analysis [10], primarily following a bottom-up approach to coding that 'lets the data speak'. I am also bringing in perspectives from critical feminist HCI and theories from CSMM as a way to further understand

and conceptualize fathers' and partners' positionalities within the realm of parenthood. To bring together the individual studies of my compilation thesis and to provide an overarching analysis of technologies of parenthood, I plan to draw inspiration from the guiding questions outlined by Bacchi's 'What's the Problem Represented to be?' approach [5, 6]. The approach was originally developed as a critical tool for (gender) policy analysis; however, I argue that the underlying assumptions and analytical questions are also well-suited to analyze the way in which both the interaction design of these apps and the way we as a community conduct research on the topic of parenthood *constructs* particular types of 'problems' and has a gendering effect rather than addressing the issue of equal parenthood.

4 Progress to date and preliminary findings

Currently in my second of five years of the PhD program, I have already completed a mandatory thesis proposal seminar where I presented the plan for this dissertation and have received valuable feedback on the research direction, the approach and the theoretical framing. For now, my focus is on writing the first two articles that will be submitted in 2026. For the second study I have completed nine interviews with fathers-to-be about their use of pregnancy apps, as well as four app walkthroughs of popular Swedish pregnancy apps used by the participants. Finalizing the analysis of the findings and writing up the results together with my supervisors happens now during spring and we plan to submit this article for the NordiCHI deadline in April. For the other article (nr. 1) on theoretical perspectives on fatherhood in HCI I am continuing my engagement with CSMM theories, fatherhood studies and mapping out existing relevant work in HCI. This article will be the foundation for the theory chapter in my dissertation manuscript, that I start writing on in 2026. After completing the ethical review process, I can also continue with the rest of the planned interview studies and co-design workshops. Preliminary findings from the second study on fathers' and partners' experiences with pregnancy apps have shown that this group occupies an interesting position between use and non-use of these apps, that I want to develop further in my analysis. Both in the interviews and in the interaction design, fathers and partners emerge as a 'secondary parent', reflecting a gap in regards to equal parenting ideals. Pregnancy is understood as a primarily physical, embodied process taking place in the female body, so the experience is highly relational for fathers and partners, as their lives are primarily affected depending on how the pregnant person feels. This leads to a strong focus on practical support such as taking over household chores, and there is little attention to the emotional or social aspects of becoming a father/co-parent in the apps or from the interviewees, which would open up the possibility of sharing this as an experience between both parents. We take feminist ethics of care and caring masculinities as an analytical lens to look at the material [15, 40]. This allows us to zoom in on the caring practices fathers and partners talk about and that apps encourage, as well as drawing out analytical themes related to positive emotions, interdependence and relationality, while keeping a critical feminist perspective on issues of gender equality, such as an equal sharing of care work and responsibilities.

5 Expected contributions

With this dissertation I aim to contribute to the field of HCI by suggesting to put fatherhood on the HCI research agenda and focusing on the perspectives of fathers and non-pregnant parents, studying their experiences in connection to gender relations in parenthood. More specifically, my expected theoretical, empirical and design contributions are as follows: first, introducing theoretical frameworks and concepts from Critical Studies of Men and Masculinities into the field of Feminist HCI, therefore furthering an understanding of men as gendered beings in HCI and adapting CSMM theories to the study of interaction, design and technology use. Second, conducting empirical studies focusing on fathers/partners and their relationships, therefore highlighting their unique positions and experiences. And third, working together with fathers, partners and couples to open up a design space to make parenting technologies for all parents and support equal parenthood. My hope is that this research will be one small step among many towards "Creating Tomorrow Together": for a more gender equal future of parenthood technology.

6 Areas for feedback

For the CHI2026 dissertation research roundtable, I would appreciate comments and feedback on all aspects of my research project, and in particular on the theoretical framing of my work: suggestions regarding specific (feminist) theories or authors that might be relevant for my topic, but also suggestions for how to incorporate the various theoretical perspectives into a coherent framing for my dissertation. I look forward to discussing our research projects with other members of the CHI community to gain new ideas, further develop my dissertation and make a meaningful contribution to CHI.

Acknowledgments

Part of this research (study nr. 2) was funded by the Swedish Research Council (project number 2020-01453).

References

- [1] Kidung Ageng. 2023. Online Information Seeking and Searching Behavior of First Time Southeast Asian Fathers. In *Proceedings of the 2023 Conference on Human Information Interaction and Retrieval*, 486–489. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3576840.3578318>
- [2] Tawfiq Ammari and Sarita Schoenebeck. 2015. Understanding and Supporting Fathers and Fatherhood on Social Media Sites. In *Proceedings of the 33rd Annual ACM Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1905–1914. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2702123.2702205>
- [3] Tawfiq Ammari and Sarita Schoenebeck. 2016. "Thanks for your interest in our Facebook group, but it's only for dads": Social Roles of Stay-at-Home Dads. In *Proceedings of the 19th ACM Conference on Computer-Supported Cooperative Work & Social Computing*, 1363–1375. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2818048.2819927>
- [4] Tawfiq Ammari, Sarita Schoenebeck, and Daniel M. Romero. 2018. Pseudonymous Parents: Comparing Parenting Roles and Identities on the Mommit and Daddit Subreddits. In *Proceedings of the 2018 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3173574.3174063>
- [5] Carol Bacchi. 2012. Introducing the 'What's the Problem Represented to be?' approach. In *Engaging with Carol Bacchi: Strategic interventions and Exchanges*, Angelique Bletsas and Chris Beasley (eds.). University of Adelaide Press, 21–24.
- [6] Carol Bacchi and Joan Eveline. 2010. Approaches to gender mainstreaming: What's the problem represented to be? In *Mainstreaming politics: Gendering practices and feminist theory*, Carol Bacchi and Joan Eveline (eds.). University of Adelaide Press, Adelaide.
- [7] Madeline Balaam, Judy Robertson, Geraldine Fitzpatrick, Rebecca Say, Gillian Hayes, Melissa Mazmanian, and Belinda Parmar. 2013. Motherhood and HCI. In

- CHI '13 Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems, 3215–3218. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2468356.2479650>
- [8] Shaowen Bardzell. 2010. Feminist HCI: Taking Stock and Outlining an Agenda for Design. In *Proceedings of the SIGCHI conference on human factors in computing systems*, 1301–1310. <https://doi.org/10.1145/1753326.1753521>
 - [9] Alan F. Blackwell. 2015. HCI as an Inter-Discipline. In *Proceedings of the 33rd Annual ACM Conference Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 503–516. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2702613.2732505>
 - [10] Virginia Braun and Victoria Clarke. 2006. Using thematic analysis in psychology. *Qualitative Research in Psychology* 3, 2: 77–101. <https://doi.org/10.1191/1478088706qp0630a>
 - [11] Tristan Bridges and C. J. Pascoe. 2014. Hybrid Masculinities: New Directions in the Sociology of Men and Masculinities. *Sociology Compass* 8, 3: 246–258. <https://doi.org/10.1111/soc4.12134>
 - [12] Vanessa Julia Carpenter and Dan Overholt. 2017. Designing For Meaningfulness: A Case Study Of A Pregnancy Wearable For Men. In *Proceedings of the 2017 ACM Conference Companion Publication on Designing Interactive Systems*, 95–100. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3064857.3079126>
 - [13] Andrea Doucet. 2018. *Do men mother? Fathering, Care, and Parental Responsibilities*. University of Toronto press, Toronto.
 - [14] Paul Dourish. 2006. Implications for Design. In *Proceedings of the SIGCHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI '06)*, 541–550. Retrieved from <https://doi.org/10.1145/1124772.1124855>
 - [15] Karla Elliott. 2016. Caring Masculinities: Theorizing an Emerging Concept. *Men and Masculinities* 19, 3: 240–259. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1097184X15576203>
 - [16] Daniel A. Epstein, Clara Caldeira, Mayara Costa Figueiredo, Xi Lu, Lucas M. Silva, Lucretia Williams, Jong Ho Lee, Qingyang Li, Simran Ahuja, Qiuer Chen, Payam Dowlatyari, Craig Hilby, Sazeda Sultana, Elizabeth V. Eikay, and Yunan Chen. 2020. Mapping and Taking Stock of the Personal Informatics Literature. *Proceedings of the ACM on Interactive, Mobile, Wearable and Ubiquitous Technologies* 4, 4: 1–38. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3432231>
 - [17] Batya Friedman, Peter H. Kahn, Alan Borning, and Alina Hultgren. 2013. Value Sensitive Design and Information Systems. In *Early engagement and new technologies: Opening up the laboratory*, Neelke Doorn, Daan Schuurbiens, Ibo Van De Poel and Michael E. Gorman (eds.). Springer Netherlands, Dordrecht, 55–95. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-94-007-7844-3_4
 - [18] Yuan Gao, Xinying Li, Yu-Hsuan Lin, Xin Liu, and Lin Pang. 2014. Nuwa: enhancing the pregnancy experience for expectant parents. In *CHI '14 Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 257–262. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2559206.2580928>
 - [19] Jeff Hearn and Richard Howson. 2020. The institutionalization of (critical) studies on men and masculinities. In *Routledge International Handbook of Masculinity Studies*, Lucas Gottzén, Ulf Mellström and Tamara Shefer (eds.). Routledge.
 - [20] Mary Hui, Christine Ly, and Carman Neustaedter. 2012. MammiBelli: sharing baby activity levels between expectant mothers and their intimate social groups. In *CHI '12 Extended Abstracts on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1649–1654. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2212776.2223687>
 - [21] Jonas Kjeldmand Jensen, Tawfiq Ammari, and Pernille Bjørn. 2019. Into Scandinavia: When Online Fatherhood Reflects Societal Infrastructures. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 3, GROUP: 1–21. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3361112>
 - [22] Been Jeon, Ji Hwan Ryu, Jaewon Cho, Byung-Chull Bae, and Jun-Dong Cho. 2015. Smart maternity clothes for visualizing fetal movement data. In *Proceedings of the 2015 ACM International Joint Conference on Pervasive and Ubiquitous Computing and Proceedings of the 2015 ACM International Symposium on Wearable Computers - UbiComp '15*, 189–192. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2800835.2800911>
 - [23] Takayuki Kosaka, Hajime Misumi, Takuya Iwamoto, Robert Songer, and Junichi Akita. 2011. “Mommy Tummy” A pregnancy experience system simulating fetal movement. In *ACM SIGGRAPH 2011 Emerging Technologies*, 1–1. <https://doi.org/10.1145/2048259.2048269>
 - [24] Ben Light, Jean Burgess, and Stefanie Duguay. 2018. The walkthrough method: An approach to the study of apps. *New Media & Society* 20, 3: 881–900. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1461444816675438>
 - [25] Jingyu Lin and Danni Chang. 2020. Babe: An Experience Sharing Design for Enhancing Fatherhood During Pregnancy. In *Design, User Experience, and Usability: Design for Contemporary Interactive Environments*, Aaron Marcus and Elizabeth Rosenzweig (eds.). Springer International Publishing, Cham, 87–98. https://doi.org/10.1007/978-3-030-49760-6_6
 - [26] Maria Lohan. 2015. Advancing research on men and reproduction. *International Journal of Men's Health* 14, 3: 214–232. <https://doi.org/10.3149/jmh.1403.214>
 - [27] Xi Lu, Jacquelyn E. Powell, Elena Agapie, Yunan Chen, and Daniel A. Epstein. 2024. Examining the Social Aspects of Pregnancy Tracking Applications. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 8, CSCW1: 1–30. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3637328>
 - [28] Xi Lu, Jacquelyn E. Powell, Elena Agapie, Yunan Chen, and Daniel A. Epstein. 2024. Unpacking the Lived Experience of Collaborative Pregnancy Tracking. In *Proceedings of the CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1–17. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3613904.3642652>
 - [29] Kai Lukoff, Carol Moser, and Sarita Schoenebeck. 2017. Gender Norms and Attitudes about Childcare Activities Presented on Father Blogs. In *Proceedings of the 2017 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 4966–4971. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3025453.3025767>
 - [30] Deborah Lupton. 2014. Apps as Artefacts: Towards a Critical Perspective on Mobile Health and Medical Apps. *Societies* 4, 4: 606–622. <https://doi.org/10.3390/soc4040606>
 - [31] Dilisha Patel, Ann Blandford, and Judith Stephenson. 2018. So you're planning a baby?: a review of preconception care apps. In *Proceedings of the 20th International Conference on Human-Computer Interaction with Mobile Devices and Services Adjunct*, 63–70. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3236112.3236121>
 - [32] Dilisha Patel, Ann Blandford, Mark Warner, Jill Shawe, and Judith Stephenson. 2019. “I feel like only half a man”: Online Forums as a Resource for Finding a “New Normal” for Men Experiencing Fertility Issues. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction* 3, CSCW: 1–20. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3359184>
 - [33] Natalia Reich-Stiebert, Laura Froehlich, and Jan-Bennet Voltmer. 2023. Gendered Mental Labor: A Systematic Literature Review on the Cognitive Dimension of Unpaid Work Within the Household and Childcare. *Sex Roles* 88, 11–12: 475–494. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s11199-023-01362-0>
 - [34] Katie Seaborn. 2023. Interacting with Masculinities: A Scoping Review. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1–12. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3544549.3585770>
 - [35] Statistics Sweden. 2022. *Women and men in Sweden: facts and figures*. Örebro.
 - [36] Kymeng Tang, Kathrin Gerling, Marnix Lijnen, Marten Geets, Luc Geurts, Maria Aufheimer, and Joke Muyldermans. 2023. 3, 2, 1 Start with Breastfeeding: Supporting Partner Involvement in Breastfeeding Education Through a Gamified Mobile App. In *Mensch und Computer 2023*, 186–196. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3603555.3603557>
 - [37] Lisa Thomas, Elizabeth Silence, Vicky Else, Emma Simpson, and Louise Moody. 2019. Technology to Mediate Role Conflict in Motherhood. In *Extended Abstracts of the 2019 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems*, 1–8. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3290607.3299024>
 - [38] Anna Vallgård, Camille Wagner-Eckert, Caroline Bøgvad Mølhave, and Harvey Bewley. 2022. PregnancyCubes: A design process to cultivate tensions. In *Nordic Human-Computer Interaction Conference*, 1–13. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3546155.3547284>
 - [39] Helena Wahlström Henriksson. 2020. Exploring fatherhood in critical gender research. In *Routledge International Handbook of Masculinity Studies* (1st ed.), Lucas Gottzén, Ulf Mellström and Tamara Shefer (eds.). Routledge, Abingdon, Oxon; New York, NY, 320–330.
 - [40] Katarzyna Wojnicka and Sam De Boise. 2025. Caring Masculinities: Rethinking the Concept. *Men and Masculinities*: 1097184X251327673. <https://doi.org/10.1177/1097184X251327673>